

C. Philosophy of Addiction

Course Description

This course is about addiction, formally termed “substance use disorder” (SUD). In learning about and discussing SUD, this course touches on selfhood, willpower, self-control, dependence, disease, normalcy, diagnostic practice, and clinical definitions. By examining the history of the substance use disorder, we will draw out what “-use disorder” means, and what, if any, effective features of the diagnostic criteria there are. In coming to understand SUD, we will cover both pathways to and remedies for addictive behavior. Throughout the semester, we will be elucidating what contributes to addictive behavior, and ask how common it is across individuals.

Grading

15%: Attendance and Participation

15%: Prospective Idea 1

15%: Prospective Idea 2

35%: Term Paper / Final Exam

20%: Weekly Assignments

Attendance and Participation

Show up on time and ready to engage. Students are allowed one free, unjustified, absence. Each absence after that will cost 1.5 percentage points from the final grade. Students will also be expected to contribute to in-class discussions. The discussions we have in class will: 1) prompt students to apply the concepts discussed in the previous classes, and 2) encourage them to remember what their fellow classmates said. **Full points on this criteria will be awarded to those who talk, in an engaged way, in at least 13 classes (ignoring workshop days).** Points will be reduced based on the number of classes with missed engagement out of the 13 required.

Weekly Assignments

Each week, students will be asked to respond to some aspect of the assigned reading. They will have a choice of how they respond (eg. for or against). Expected length: 100 - 150 words. These will serve as discussion points in class and due two hours before class at the beginning of the week.

Prospective Ideas

Students will be asked to undergo the beginning stages of writing a paper—twice. When submitting a “prospective idea” in its gradable form, it will not be a full paper, but rather the idea of a full paper in the form of a developed outline or really rough draft. The first prospective idea will mainly draw on one’s intuitive interests as she enters the class; it will be due by Week 5. The second prospective idea will draw more majorly on the material we cover in class, due on Week 10. It may be inspired by one’s first prospective idea, but students are encouraged to conjure new ideas as well.

Term Paper

The term paper is the main product of this class. The final paper must draw on one of the two P.Is., and be 3500 words maximum. While the students are expected to present their term papers, they will not be graded on this presentation further than the “participation” grade.

Students will have the option of taking a final exam, rather than submitting a final paper. The exam will consist of written responses to concept identification questions and essay prompts. If students fail to submit at least one prospective idea, they default to taking the final exam.

University Policies

Americans With Disabilities Act (ADA)

The University of Utah seeks to provide equal access to its programs, services, and activities for people with disabilities.

All written information in this course can be made available in an alternative format with prior notification to the Center for Disability & Access (CDA). CDA will work with you and the instructor to make arrangements for accommodations. Prior notice is appreciated. To read the full accommodations policy for the University of Utah, please see Section Q of the Instruction & Evaluation regulations.

In compliance with ADA requirements, some students may need to record course content. Any recordings of course content are for personal use only, should not be shared, and should never be made publicly available. In addition, recordings must be destroyed at the conclusion of the course.

If you will need accommodations in this class, or for more information about what support they provide, contact:

Center for Disability & Access

801-581-5020
disability.utah.edu
65 Student Services Building
201 S 1460 E
Salt Lake City, UT 84112

Safety at the U

The University of Utah values the safety of all campus community members. You will receive important emergency alerts and safety messages regarding campus safety via text message. For more safety information and to view available training resources, including helpful videos, visit safeu.utah.edu.

To report suspicious activity or to request a courtesy escort, contact:

Campus Police & Department of Public Safety

801-585-COPS (801-585-2677)
dps.utah.edu
1735 E. S. Campus Dr.
Salt Lake City, UT 84112

Addressing Sexual Misconduct

Title IX makes it clear that violence and harassment based on sex and gender (which includes sexual orientation and gender identity/expression) is a civil rights offense subject to the same kinds of accountability and the same kinds of support applied to offenses against other protected categories such as race, national origin, color, religion, age, status as a person with a disability, veteran's status, or genetic information.

If you or someone you know has been harassed or assaulted, you are encouraged to report it to university officials:

Title IX Coordinator & Office of Equal Opportunity and Affirmative Action

801-581-8365
oeo.utah.edu
135 Park Building

201 Presidents' Cir.
Salt Lake City, UT 84112

Office of the Dean of Students

801-581-7066
deanofstudents.utah.edu
270 Union Building
200 S. Central Campus Dr.
Salt Lake City, UT 84112

To file a police report, contact:

Campus Police & Department of Public Safety

801-585-COPS (801-585-2677)
dps.utah.edu
1735 E. S. Campus Dr.
Salt Lake City, UT 84112

If you do not feel comfortable reporting to authorities, the U's Victim-Survivor Advocates provide free, confidential, and trauma-informed support services to students, faculty, and staff who have experienced interpersonal violence.

To privately explore options and resources available to you with an advocate, contact:

Center for Campus Wellness

801-581-7776
wellness.utah.edu
350 Student Services Building
201 S. 1460 E.
Salt Lake City, UT 84112

Academic Misconduct

It is expected that students comply with University of Utah policies regarding academic honesty, including but not limited to refraining from cheating, plagiarizing, misrepresenting one's work, and/or inappropriately collaborating. This includes the use of generative artificial intelligence (AI) tools without citation, documentation, or authorization. Students are expected to adhere to the prescribed professional and ethical standards of the profession/discipline for which they are

preparing. Any student who engages in academic dishonesty or who violates the professional and ethical standards for their profession/discipline may be subject to academic sanctions as per the University of Utah's Student Code: Policy 6-410: Student Academic Performance, Academic Conduct, and Professional and Ethical Conduct.

Plagiarism and cheating are serious offenses and may be punished by failure on an individual assignment, and/or failure in the course. Academic misconduct, according to the University of Utah Student Code:

"...Includes, but is not limited to, cheating, misrepresenting one's work, inappropriately collaborating, plagiarism, and fabrication or falsification of information...It also includes facilitating academic misconduct by intentionally helping or attempting to help another to commit an act of academic misconduct."

For details on plagiarism and other important course conduct issues, see the U's Code of Student Rights and Responsibilities.

Course Calendar

Please note that the schedule is subject to change as the semester progresses; all changes will be announced through Canvas.

Fall 3350 Schedule

All readings can be found on Canvas

Module 1: Self Control

Week 1: Introduction

- *August 20th*
 - Read:
 - Syllabus
- *August 22nd*
 - Read
 - *Amaya 2020*, The Science of Self Control

Week 2: Breaking Down Self Control

- *August 27th*
 - Read:
 - *Herdova 2017*, Self-control and mechanisms of behavior: Why self-control is not a natural mental kind
- *August 29th*

- Optional:
 - *Sripada 2020*, The Atoms of Self Control

Explain: Prospectus 1 Assignment

Week 3: Self Control, Broken

- *September 3rd*
 - Read:
 - *Allom et al 2016*, Self-report and behavioural approaches to the measurement of self-control: Are we assessing the same construct?
- *September 5th*
 - Read:
 - *Saunders et al. 2018*, Reported Self-control is not Meaningfully Associated with Inhibition-related Executive Function: A Bayesian Analysis

Week 4: Self-Control, Still Broken

- *September 10th*
 - Read:
 - *Brownstein 2018*, Self-Control and Overcontrol: Conceptual, Ethical, and Ideological Issues in Positive Psychology
- *September 12th*
 - Read:
 - *Schwitzgebel 2008*, The Unreliability of Naive Introspection

Week 5: Effort: an epic tale

- *September 17th*
 - Read:
 - *Friese et al. 2019*, Is Ego Depletion Real? An Analysis of Arguments
- *September 19th*
 - Read:
 - *Inzlicht et al. 2018*, The Effort Paradox: Effort Is Both Costly and Valued

Week 6: Commitment Devices

- *September 24th*
 - *Bryan et al. 2020*, Commitment Devices
- *September 26th*
 - Group work day

Prospectus 1 is due by 11:59pm, Sunday, September 29th.

Module 2: Disease

Week 7: Addiction is a Disease

- *October 1st*
 - Read:
 - *Leshner 1997, Addiction is a Brain Disease, and It Matters*
- *October 3rd*
 - Read:
 - *Flanagan 2011, What is it Like to be an Addict?*

Week 8: FALL BREAK

Week 9: Or is it?

- *October 15th*
 - Read:
 - *Pickard 2021, Is addiction a brain disease? A plea for agnosticism and heterogeneity*
- *October 17th*
 - Read:
 - *Luhrmann et al 2015, Hearing Voices in Different Cultures: A Social Kindling Hypothesis*

Week 10: Case Studies

- *October 22nd*
 - Read:
 - *Bruce Alexander: The View from Rat Park (available online)*
- *October 24th*
 - Read
 - *Burroughs 1956, Letter from a Master Addict to Dangerous Drugs*

Week 11: Brief History of DSM Addiction Diagnosis

- *October 29th*
 - Read:
 - *Robinson and Adinoff 2016, The Classification of Substance Use Disorders: Historical, Contextual, and Conceptual Considerations*
- *October 31st: Happy Halloween!*
 - Reading:
 - *Norko and Fitch 2014, DSM-5 and Substance Use Disorders: Clinicolegal Implications*

Week 12: Addiction, Self-Control, and Evaluations

- *November 5th*
 - Read:
 - *Sripada 2021*, Impaired control in addiction involves cognitive distortions and unreliable self-control, not compulsive desires and overwhelmed self-control
 - Optional:
 - *Berkman et al 2017*, Self-Control as Value-Based Choice
- *November 7th*
 - Read:
 - *Pickard 2018*, The Puzzle of Addiction
 - Optional:
 - *Sripada 2018*, Addiction and Fallibility

Prospectus 2 is due by 11:59pm, Sunday, November 10th.

Module 3: Closing Out

Week 13:

- November 12th
 - TBD
- November 14th
 - TBD

Week 14: Workshop and Discussion

- November 19th
 - TBD
- November 21st
 - Paper writing workshop

Week 15: Presentations

- November 26th
 - *Paper presentations*
- November 28th
 - HOLIDAY BREAK

Week 16—Final week: Presentations

December 3rd - December 5th

- December 3rd
 - *Paper presentations*
- December 5th

- *Paper presentations*

Term Paper is due by 11:59pm, Sunday, December 8th.

Grades Due: Monday, December 23rd.